

THE HOLE IN THE OZONE LAYER IS A KIND OF SKYWRITING

OZONE DEPLETION

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

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BEFORE

1974 American chemists Frank “Sherry” Rowland and Mario Molina suggest that chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs) destroy atmospheric ozone.

1976 The US National Academy of Sciences declares that ozone depletion is a reality.

AFTER

1987 The Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer, a global treaty to phase out CFCs and similar chemicals, is agreed.

1989 Montreal’s worldwide ban on the production of CFCs comes into effect (ratified by 197 countries to date).

2066 The year in which ozone over the Antarctic is predicted to fully recover; however, other harmful emissions may delay recovery.

In 1982, a team of scientists working for the British Antarctic Survey (BAS) discovered that ozone levels above the Antarctic had fallen dramatically. Ozone (O_3, a colorless gas in the stratosphere, 12–18 miles (20–30 km)